

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

6th November, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

45th WEEK



AUNG SAN & ROHINGYAS

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.



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LIVE



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

6th NOVEMBER, 2017

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Suu Kyi in denial

The global community cannot afford to ignore Myanmar's treatment of the Rohingya.

Nearly three months after violence escalated against the Rohingya in Myanmar's Rakhine State, leading to the exodus of more than half a million to neighbouring Bangladesh, State Counsellor Aung San Suu Kyi finally visited the region. By all accounts, Ms. Suu Kyi had little more than platitudes to offer and her words showed no recognition that what transpired is a "textbook example of ethnic cleansing", as the UN Human Rights chief put it. This is extremely disappointing. Ms. Suu Kyi endured years of house arrest and unremitting hostility from the military junta before emerging victorious in a free and fair election two years ago. But despite taking over a top post after the election, her civilian government's powers have been clipped as the military still holds sway over defence, home affairs and border issues. Ms. Suu Kyi, a recipient of the Nobel Peace Prize, has found it pragmatic not to challenge the official rhetoric in Myanmar, which suggests the military's actions were aimed at tackling "terror" in Rakhine. This could be for two reasons. First, she does not want to upset the fragile balance of power in the fledgling democracy after years of rule by the junta. Second, there is a clear lack of empathy for the Rohingya in a country that has seen the rise of Buddhist and Bamar majoritarianism that has corresponded with an official "othering" of the Rohingya, who are Muslims, as non-citizens. Despite the widespread international condemnation of her government's actions, Ms. Suu Kyi has sought to pander to the domestic gallery by defending the military's actions in Rakhine. Her conduct during her visit to the region this week suggests that she has no intention of effecting any real or meaningful change in her government's position on the Rohingya.

The Rohingya, meanwhile, have been left to deal with themselves, unwanted and stateless in their homeland and forced to migrate, mostly to Bangladesh, in hazardous conditions. Dhaka has been trying to drum up support and relief for the constant and unremitting stream of refugees making their way to Bangladeshi soil. Against this background, it is unfortunate that New Delhi has turned its back on the Rohingya refugees, leading to perceptions that it has failed to rise to its status as a regional power and take the lead in dealing with the humanitarian crisis. The Myanmar government has said that it will repatriate returning Rohingya if they prove they were residents of Rakhine, but it is not clear how the refugees would be able to do so having been denied citizenship and having fled their villages under duress with barely anything in hand. Myanmar's evasiveness makes it all the more imperative that the international community, including India, quickly provide succour for the hundreds of thousands of Rohingya who are living on the edge.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date : 4th November, 2017

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AUNG SAN SUU KYI
STATE COUNSELLOR, MYANMAR

NEWS REPORT

- Aung San Suu Kyi visited the region three months after the violence escalated against Rohingyas in Myanmar's Rakhine State.
- It led to the exodus of more than half a million to the neighbouring Bangladesh.
- Human Rights Chief puts it as a "textbook example of ethnic cleansing".



MYANMAR



FACT FILE ON MYANMAR

- *Region* ... SE Asia
- *Population* ... 53 million
- *Religion* ... Buddhism
- *Capital* ... Naypyidaw
- *Currency* ... Burmese kyat

1 The Constitution was drafted by the military

2 Article 59F says anyone with foreign children is ineligible to become President

3 25% of the seats in Parliament reserved for military (unelected armed forces)

4 Commander-in-Chief will nominate the heads of three powerful Ministries viz., Home Affairs, Defence & Border Affairs.

FACTUAL INFORMATION



1 Rohingyas belong to Muslim sect.

2 They are one of Myanmar's many ethnic minorities.

3 Rohingyas say that they are descendants of Arab traders who have been in the region for generations.

4 Myanmar Government sees them as illegal immigrants from Bangladesh.

5 The Country also denies them the citizenship as per the Citizenship Law 1982.

6 Myanmar is predominantly Buddhist country.

7 It has a long history of communal mistrust.

8 The country has been under the Military rule for several years and this mistrust is exploited by the army.

INDIA

NEPAL

BANGLADESH

Myanmar
(Burma)

VIETNAM

Lao PDR

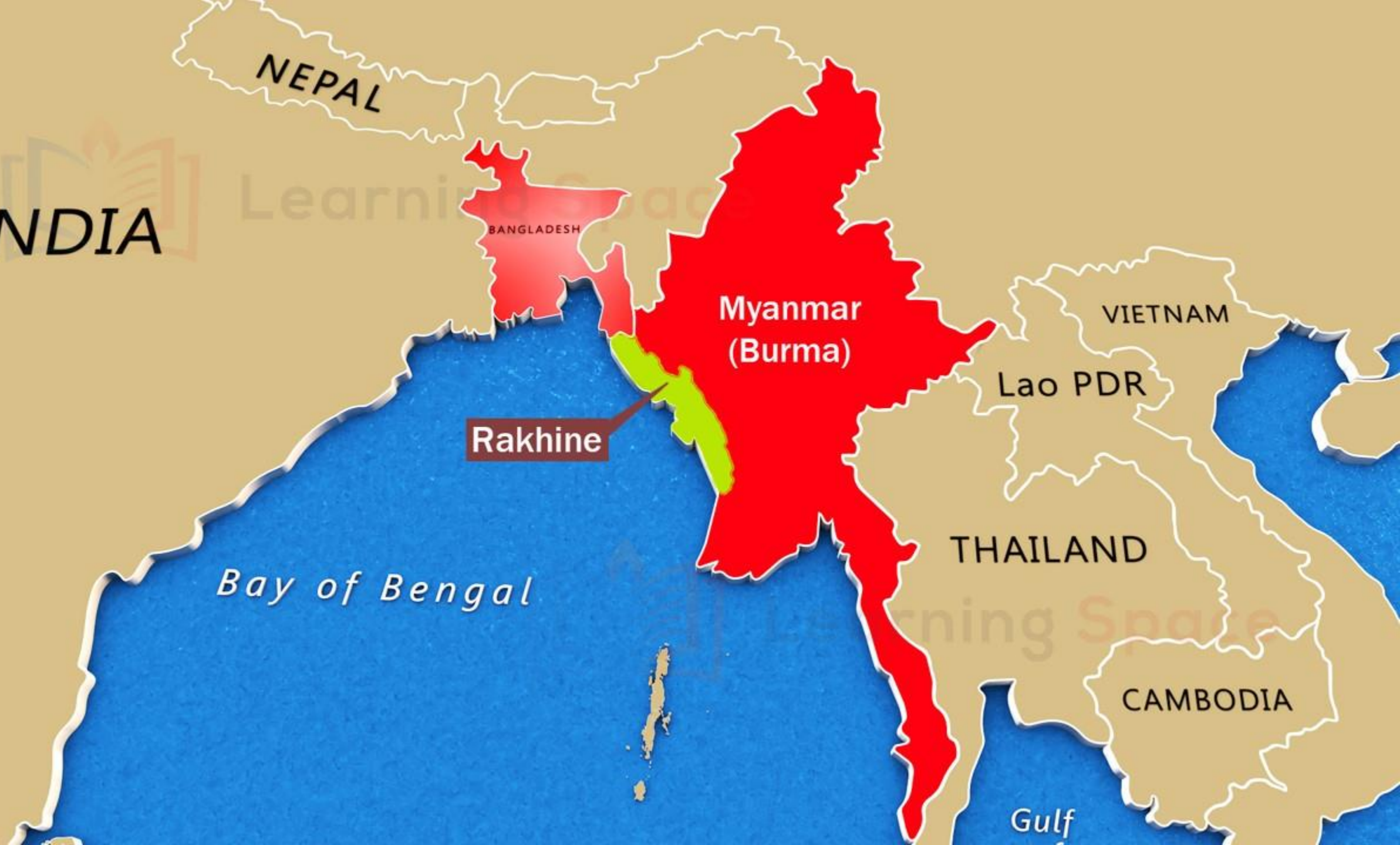
Rakhine

THAILAND

CAMBODIA

Bay of Bengal

Gulf





WHAT CAN BE THE PROBABLE REASONS FOR THIS SITUATION?

- 1 Her civilian Government powers have already been clipped as the military still holds sway over defence, home affairs and border issues.
- 2 She does not want to upset the fragile balance of power in the fledgling democracy, after years of rule by the military junta.
- 3 There is a clear lack of empathy for the Rohingyas in a country that has seen the rise of Buddhist and Bamar Majoritarianism, which led to the official “Othering” of Rohingyas, who are Muslims as non citizens.

The need of the hour is that the international community, including India, quickly provides succour for the hundreds of thousands of the refugees, who are living on the edge.

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